

Sruthi Rao Gangapuram
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Summary

- PMP-certified biotechnology professional with 10+ years of progressive experience engaging with cross-functional teams and delivering complex biotech projects (Formulation and Drug Product Development, Upstream and Downstream Process Development) within scope, budget and regulatory timelines.
 - Proven success in leading Development, Manufacturing, Validation initiatives ensuring regulatory compliance and aligning project goals with organizational strategy.
 - Skilled in process optimization, data-driven decision-making and cross-functional collaborations.
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WORK EXPERIENCE

Associate Scientist - Drug Product Development

Mar 2021 - Feb 2024

Sr. Research Associate - Drug Product Development

Research Associate - Drug Product Development

Gritstone bio, Pleasanton, CA

- Developed and executed pre-formulation, formulation and process development studies/projects (of Lipid Nanoparticles and Adenoviral vectors) under GMP standards, in alignment with business goals for Phase-I, Phase-II programs and commercial readiness.
- Managed and streamlined daily activities to ensure alignment with company timelines.
- Tracked study progress and activity assignment using Smartsheet.
- Reduced analytical characterization time via process optimization by 25%.
- Coordinated material request, study logistics and testing for additional attributes with DS and Analytical groups.
- Conducted Clinical In-use compatibility and syringe stability studies to enable/support product preparation and administration instructions in Pharmacy Manual. Worked on compatibility studies with various container closure systems (vials, stoppers, seals).
- Authored and reviewed protocols, reports and presented the findings to DP and CMC groups. Have been part of budget planning and risk management.
- Trained and led contractors for supporting short term projects.

Associate I & II - Process Development & Manufacturing

Jun 2017 – Mar 2021

Gritstone bio, Pleasanton, CA

- Collaborated on scale-up of mammalian cells (shake flasks to 50L bioreactor), viral production, viral purification process (AKTA – size exclusion chromatography, ion exchange chromatography and TFF) and technology transfer from development to manufacturing.
- Planned and conducted IND-enabling studies to support IND application to regulatory agencies.
- Participated in budgeting and forecasting to mitigate the risk of supply chain disruptions by looking into dual sourcing and maintaining safe stock levels in-house.
- Supported quality audits and ensured adherence to GMP/GLP standards.
- Oversaw project coordination for RNA drug substance processes (using small scale PCR techniques) and LNP process development (mRNA encapsulation and downstream purification)
- Compiled the data, summaries, authored reports, presented the data to support process improvements.
- Assisted in setting up the new Manufacturing facility and validating new equipment.
- Established and drafted procedures enabling developing Batch Records, documenting deviations in GMP operations, change controls and CAPAs, risk management.

Associate - Validation

Oct 2015 – Dec 2016

Dynavax, Berkeley, CA

- Responsible for managing Validation lifecycle documents such as Validation Plans, User Requirements Specification, Risk Management Plan and Validation Reports for computer systems related to GxP and Biological/Clinical processes.
- Validation/qualifying and testing quality systems that deal with biological product complaints and issues, as per Good Automated Manufacturing Practices (GAMP).
- Working with Dynavax staff to identify business requirements and process solutions.
- Tracing the functionality of the purchased systems to match with the business requirements (R&D, Clinical, QA, IT).

- Author SOPs, work instructions in compliance with Documentation Management process and procedures.
- Work with project teams to identify, analyze, prioritize, document and communicate project risks to mitigate impact to project deliverables and timeline.

Research Associate - Cell Culture

Jan 2015 – Jul 2015

MedImmune, Gaithersburg, MD

- Executed developmental runs in bench-scale bioreactors and shake flasks, aseptic technique for mammalian cell culture.
- Troubleshoot cell culture and bioreactor operations to ensure a consistent high yield of product, protein purification with chromatography.
- Evaluation of cell line selection, cell viability, transient transfection procedures and maintain cell culture equipment.
- Proficient with compliance requirements within cGMP, GLP guidelines, safety, and regulatory environments.
- Underwent preliminary training in flow cytometry.

Intern - Formulation Sciences

Jul 2014 – Nov 2014

MedImmune, Gaithersburg, MD

- Carried out buffer/excipient preparation, pre-formulation studies, formulation characterization and stability studies of nucleic acids at different excipients composition and concentration via
 - biophysical/analytical methods including UV-Vis, particle sizing by Dynamic Light Scattering (DLS), CD spectroscopy, Differential Scanning Calorimetry (DSC), and Isothermal Calorimetry (ITC).
- Characterized the interaction of cationic lipids and polycationic amino acids on the structure and stability of nucleic acids.
- Acquired, compiled, analyzed, and presented the stability data.

Graduate Student Lab Assistant

Feb 2013 - Sep 2013; Jan 2014 - May 2014

Control of Miniaturized Systems Laboratory, University of Maryland, College Park, MD

- Handling and dissecting rat tissue samples.
- Assisted in histological studies to analyze the diffusion of magnetic nanoparticles injected into rat tissue samples.
- Processed and evaluated the data for further examination.

Manufacturing Technician

Sep 2013 – Dec 2013

Meso Scale Diagnostics, Rockville, MD

- Physical inventory maintenance by aliquoting, vialing and labeling kit components and documentation.
- Maintain and report raw material, reagent and/or coated plate inventories.
- Assembled kits and biological assays for biotechnology and biopharmaceutical industries/clients.

PUBLICATIONS

Quantifying the motion of magnetic particles in tissue: Effect of particle properties and applied magnetic field.

Sandip Kulkarni, Bharath Ramaswamy, Emily Horton, Sruthi Gangapuram, Alek Nacev, Didier Depireux, Mika Shimoji, Benjamin Shapiro. *Journal of Magnetism and Magnetic Materials*. Volume 393, 1 November 2015, 243-252

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Project Management Professional (PMP)

July 2024

Project Management Institute

Mini-MBA in BioPharma Innovation

April 2021

Rutgers Business School

Master of Engineering in Bioengineering

May 2014

University of Maryland, College Park, MD

Bachelor of Technology in Biotechnology

May 2012

Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, Hyderabad, India